

ALEJANDRO VALADEZ

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SUMMARY

IMSA sophomore focused on aerospace engineering, finance, and business. Led a model rocket team in an Airbus-partnered program in Toulouse, has run a seasonal food business since 2023, and builds software tools in TypeScript and Python.

EDUCATION

Illinois Mathematics and Science Academy (IMSA)

Aug 2026 – Present

Class of 2029, Sophomore

Aurora, IL

Illinois' statewide residential public academy for students advanced in mathematics and science. Admitted for sophomore year.

- Coursework: Chemistry, Geometry I/II, Methods in Scientific Inquiry, French III, Literary Explorations I, Financial Empowerment Class.

Jones College Prep

Aug 2025 – Jun 2026

Freshman Year

Chicago, IL

Selective-enrollment public high school; commuted two hours a day.

- GPA: 4.0 unweighted / 4.8 weighted.

Ebinger Elementary School

Through Jun 2025

International Baccalaureate Middle Years Programme

Chicago, IL

- State Seal of Biliteracy in Spanish; IB Principled Learner and Open-Minded Student awards.

AEROSPACE ENGINEERING

CIEE Aerospace Engineering Program, in partnership with Airbus

Jun 2026 – Jul 2026

Scholarship Recipient; Rocket Team Lead

Toulouse, France

Month-long summer program with daily classes taught by three doctorate-level instructors, held with INSA Toulouse, a leading French engineering university.

- Led my team through 8 workshops to design a model rocket in OpenRocket, then build and launch it.
- When our parachute failed a bench test, the team reinforced the heat shield and upgraded the suspension cord; the rocket flew straight on launch day.
- Walked an Airbus assembly line and toured Toulouse's aerospace museums.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Student Government Association, Jones College Prep

Sep 2025 – Jun 2026

Elected Vice President, Class of 2029

Chicago, IL

Officer on the elected board that represents the freshman class and runs its events and fundraising.

- Set up and ran class board meetings, gathered classmates' ideas, and brought them to the board for a vote.
- Wrote the board's meeting reports plus mid-year and end-of-year reports to school administration.
- Helped plan and run 6 events: a Winter Movie Night, a Valentine's anonymous-card fundraiser, a spring dance poster workshop, a flower-crown workshop, and photobooths.
- Worked with administration to get the school's first underclassmen Spring Dance approved; the dance raised \$3,000 for the class.

IMSA PROMISE Program

Aug 2026 – Present

Tutor, 9th Grade

Aurora, IL

IMSA's Saturday and summer STEM enrichment program for students working toward the academy. Completed it as a student from Feb 2023 to Jun 2026.

- Tutor 9th-grade students during Saturday sessions, about 6 hours a week.
- Bring three years of experience on the student side of the same program, from 7th grade through admission to IMSA.

Student Government Association, Ebinger Elementary

Sep 2023 – Jun 2025

8th Grade Class President (2024–25); Member (2023–24)

Chicago, IL

- Organized 3 school dances: a Hawaiian-themed dance, a Halloween dance, and a winter formal.
- Helped set up and run IB Nights, the school's open houses for prospective families.
- Set up restaurant partnerships: customers who mentioned the school got 15% off, and 15% of those sales went back to the class.

Ebinger Elementary Musicals

Dec 2023 – Mar 2025

Stage Manager, The Lion King Jr. and Beauty and the Beast Jr.

Chicago, IL

- Coordinated the sound and lights crews through rehearsals and live performances for two productions.
- Caught a falling set piece during a live show and got it back in place mid-scene.

ENTREPRENEURSHIP & FINANCE

Shaved Ice & Caramel Apple Stand

2023 – Present

Founder and Owner

Chicago, IL

Seasonal food business: shaved ice in the summer, caramel apple cups in the fall.

- Run the whole operation: sourcing local syrups, inventory, pricing, setup and teardown, storage, equipment maintenance, and marketing.
- Sell shaved ice at \$2 a cup against about \$0.60 in cost, for about \$150 a day in profit; caramel apple slice cups sell for \$5 and bring in about \$200 a day in profit.
- Built 5,000+ followers across Instagram, Facebook, Snapchat, and Nextdoor, backed by yard signs and flags around the neighborhood.
- Sold part of the business to my younger brother in 2026; he now runs it day to day while I keep a share of the profits.

Personal Investing and Options Trading

Since age 10

Self-directed investor

- Hold VOO as a long-term core position with QQQ as the higher-risk holding; day and swing trade options, mostly calls on TSLA, AAPL, and GOOGL.
- Earned about \$15,000 in lifetime trading gains, net positive; after losing more than \$5,000 to emotional trades, set a take-profit and stop-loss on every position.

PROJECTS & RESEARCH

Canvas LMS MCP Server

Open source, MIT

Creator | TypeScript, Node.js, Model Context Protocol, Canvas API

github.com/f1alej/canvas-mcp

- Built an MCP server that lets Claude read Canvas courses, assignments, rubrics, discussions, submissions, and .docx attachments, and submit work from the chat.
- Runs a daily sync that feeds my Canvas assignments into a Notion tracker.

Le Grand Tour

Fall 2026

Sole Developer | TypeScript, Vercel, Roblox, Luau

le-grand-tour.vercel.app

French III class project; I built every part of it.

- Built a multiplayer French-review board game for 2 to 6 players who play from their phones, first as a website and then as a published Roblox game scripted in Luau.

Runaway Ramps: Slowing Down With Science

Aug 2024 – May 2025

Independent Researcher | Experimental Design, Data Analysis

Published on ResearchGate

Physics study modeled on the runaway truck ramps built along steep highways.

- Built a ramp-and-RC-car rig and measured stopping distance on 4 surfaces: gravel (0.41 m), sand (0.48 m), concrete (0.84 m), and glass (1.21 m).
- Showed surface texture drives stopping distance: gravel stopped the car in about a third of the distance glass needed.
- Won local and regional Gold Awards, advanced from the Chicago Exhibition of Student STEM Research, and earned a Silver Award at the IJAS State Exposition.

Avenues to Kindness

Aug 2024 – May 2025

Project Lead, IB MYP Community Project

Chicago, IL

- Partnered with a disability-independence organization to design and deliver 90 handmade cards to its residents.
- Earned the Tim Heneghan S.O.A.R. Award (1 of 2 in the graduating class) and the IB Principled Learner Award for disability advocacy.

Personal Portfolio and Smaller Tools

2025 – Present

Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Vercel, Python, Flask

alejandrovaladez.me

- Built and deploy my portfolio site and a link-in-bio page on Vercel.
- Wrote mathutils, a small Python library with a Flask calculator front end.

HONORS & AWARDS

4.0 Unweighted / 4.8 Weighted GPA, Freshman Year, Jones College Prep

Jun 2026

Admitted, Class of 2029, Illinois Mathematics and Science Academy (State) <i>Admitted to Illinois' residential public academy for students advanced in mathematics and science.</i>	May 2026
Quarterfinalist, Northwestern Policy Debate City Championship (Regional)	Mar 2026
1st Place, Student Video Team Math Contest, Jones College Prep (Regional)	Nov 2025
Selected Team Starter, Algebra 1 Contest, City of Chicago Math League (Regional)	Sep 2025
Elected Vice President, Class of 2029, Jones College Prep (School)	Sep 2025
SEAMS Diligent Scholar Award, Illinois Mathematics and Science Academy (State)	Jun 2025
State Seal of Biliteracy in Spanish, Illinois State Board of Education (State)	Jun 2025
Tim Heneghan S.O.A.R. Award, Ebinger Elementary (School) <i>Socially Active, Open-minded, Accountable, and Respectful. 1 of 2 in the graduating class, for "Avenues to Kindness."</i>	Jun 2025
IB Principled Learner Award for Disability Advocacy, Ebinger Elementary (School) <i>Awarded for the "Avenues to Kindness" project.</i>	Jun 2025
Silver Award, 98th Annual State Exposition, Illinois Junior Academy of Science (IJAS) (State) <i>For independent research, "Runaway Ramps: Slowing Down With Science."</i>	May 2025
Advanced to State, 75th Annual Chicago Exhibition of Student STEM Research (Regional) <i>Advanced to the IJAS State Exposition with "Runaway Ramps."</i>	Mar 2025
Gold Award, Regional STEM Exhibition (Regional)	Feb 2025
Gold Award, Local Science Fair, Ebinger Elementary (School)	Dec 2024
IB Open-Minded Student Award, Ebinger Elementary (School)	Dec 2023

ACTIVITIES

Illinois Mathematics and Science Academy

AEROSpace Club (AERO): <i>Student club for aerospace design and rocketry.</i>	Aug 2026 – Present
IMSA Society of Engineers (ISE): <i>Engineering club for hands-on design projects.</i>	Aug 2026 – Present
Physics Club	Aug 2026 – Present
TALENT (Total Applied Learning for Entrepreneurs): <i>IMSA's entrepreneurship and innovation program.</i>	Aug 2026 – Present
Financial Empowerment Class (FEC): <i>Personal finance and investing course.</i>	Aug 2026 – Present
Speech Team	Aug 2026 – Present
IMSA Student Productions (ISP): <i>Student theater productions.</i>	Aug 2026 – Present
Alma Latina: <i>Latino cultural student organization.</i>	Aug 2026 – Present
Intramural Sports	Aug 2026 – Present

Jones College Prep

Rocketry Club	Sep 2025 – Jun 2026
Engineering Club	Sep 2025 – Jun 2026
Artificial Intelligence Leaders	Sep 2025 – Jun 2026
Math Team	Sep 2025 – Jun 2026
Future Business Leaders of America (FBLA): <i>National business and entrepreneurship student organization.</i>	Sep 2025 – Jun 2026
Debate Team (Policy Debate): <i>Quarterfinalist, Northwestern Policy Debate City Championship.</i>	Sep 2025 – Jun 2026
Red Cross Club	Sep 2025 – Jun 2026
Mexican American Cultural Exploration and Expression	Sep 2025 – Jun 2026
Formula 1 Fan Club	Sep 2025 – Jun 2026
IMSA PROMISE Program, Student: <i>Weekend and summer sessions, 7th grade to admission.</i>	Feb 2023 – Jun 2026

Ebinger Elementary School

Science Fair: <i>Runaway Ramps research; local Gold, regional Gold, state Silver.</i>	Aug 2024 – May 2025
MYP Community Projects: <i>Led "Avenues to Kindness."</i>	Aug 2024 – May 2025
World Club	Sep 2023 – Jun 2024
Soccer Team (Fall 2024) and Basketball Team (Winters 2023–24, 2024–25)	Dec 2023 – Jan 2025

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Software: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Tailwind CSS, Luau (Roblox), Git/GitHub, MCP, Vercel
Engineering & Research: OpenRocket, experimental design, data analysis
Finance: Options trading, ETF investing, risk management with take-profit and stop-loss orders, TradingView, Robinhood
Languages: English (native), Spanish (bilingual, State Seal of Biliteracy), French (intermediate, French III)